

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

AUGUST 4, 2026

Oil Cracks

OPEC+ finalizes rollback of voluntary cuts and Iran talks turn duplicitous as WTI collapses over 5%, Dow prints a record close on cyclical rotation, and AMD delivers the Q2 catalyst tonight after the bell.

S&P 500	NASDAQ	WTI (USO)	AMD (PRE-PRINT)	FEAR & GREED
\$757.67 ↑1.42%	\$700.07 ↑1.76%	\$122.12 ↓5.46%	\$484.64 ↑1.78%	CNN approx. 42 (Fear) per MacroMicro Jul 31 · data drop crypto fallback 25

Markets — The Dow Prints a Record Close per CNBC as the Cyclical Rotation Broadens on the Weekend OPEC+ Decision to Complete the Rollback of Voluntary Cuts With a 188,000 bpd September Increase per Al Arabiya / Egypt Oil & Gas, WTI Collapses Approximately ↓5.46% Alongside Brent Approximately ↓5.06% per Data Drop, and Palantir's Q2 Beat Powers the Merchant-Silicon Cohort Into AMD's After-Close Print Tonight per AMD Investor Relations

MONDAY DELIVERED A BROAD CYCLICAL BID ALONGSIDE A PHYSICAL-CRUDE BREAK — THE S&P 500 CLOSED ↑1.42% AT \$757.67, THE NASDAQ ↑1.76% AT \$700.07, THE DOW ↑1.32% AT \$531.22 PER DATA DROP, AND THE RUSSELL 2K ↑1.72% AT \$296.22; THE SECTOR COMPOSITION RAN COMM SERVICES (XLC) ↑2.86%, INDUSTRIALS (XLI) ↑1.85%, DISCRETIONARY (XLY) ↑1.83%, AND TECH (XLK) ↑1.53% AGAINST ENERGY (XLE) ↓1.28% AS THE CRUDE COMPLEX ABSORBED BOTH THE OPEC+ WEEKEND DECISION PER AL ARABIYA AND THE ATTEMPTED TRUMP-IRAN DIPLOMATIC FRAMING PER CNBC, WITH THE ISM MANUFACTURING PMI PRINTING 55.6 — THE HIGHEST READING SINCE MAY 2022 PER REUTERS / ISM — AGAINST A 54.0 CONSENSUS PER INVESTING LIVE

Per data drop, Monday's tape delivered a broad cyclical bid with the S&P 500 closing ↑1.42% at \$757.67 (range \$748.80–\$758.58), the Nasdaq ↑1.76% at \$700.07, the Dow ↑1.32% at \$531.22 (a fresh record close per CNBC coverage), and the Russell 2K ↑1.72% at \$296.22 as sector leadership ran Comm Services (XLC) ↑2.86%, Industrials (XLI) ↑1.85%, Discretionary (XLY) ↑1.83%, and Tech (XLK) ↑1.53%, with Energy (XLE) ↓1.28% the sole material laggard. Per Al Arabiya and Egypt Oil & Gas coverage of the OPEC+ 7 weekend virtual meeting, Saudi Arabia, Russia, Iraq, Kuwait, Kazakhstan, Algeria and Oman agreed to raise September output by 188,000 bpd, completing the phased rollback of the 1.65 million bpd voluntary supply cut originally agreed in 2023 — a fundamental supply pivot that combined with the Trump-Iran diplomatic framing per CNBC to drive WTI approximately ↓5.46% (USO \$122.12) and Brent approximately ↓5.06% (BNO \$47.83) per data drop. Per ISM and Reuters coverage of the July release, the Manufacturing PMI printed 55.6 — 2.3 points above June's 53.3 and the highest reading since May 2022 — versus a 54.0 consensus per Investing Live, with the New Orders Index at 56.7 continuing the expansionary composition. For FCI positioning, the composition frames a session where the Upstream sleeve absorbed the crude repricing (CVX \$193.18 ↓1.85%, OKE \$88.24 ↓2.83% despite its Q2 beat per Yahoo, CNX \$36.04 ↑0.67% per data drop) while the Utility-AI-power sleeve (VST \$155.94 ↑5.23%, CEG \$273.71 ↑4.17%) and the merchant-silicon cohort (CRDO \$218.35 ↑5.49%, NVDA \$206.64 ↑2.93%, MRVL \$193.78 ↑3.31% per data drop) captured the load-growth and AI-platform bid into tonight's AMD print.

S&P 500	\$757.67 · ↑1.42% · Dow record close per CNBC
NASDAQ	\$700.07 · ↑1.76% on the PLTR / AI-adjacent bid
WTI (USO)	\$122.12 · ↓approx. 5.46% on OPEC+ + Iran framing per data drop
BRENT (BNO)	\$47.83 · ↓approx. 5.06% per data drop
OPEC+ SEPTEMBER	+188,000 bpd · completes rollback of voluntary cuts per Al Arabiya / Egypt Oil & Gas
ISM MANUFACTURING PMI	55.6 · highest since May 2022 per Reuters / ISM · vs. 54.0 est per Investing Live
UTILITY-AI SLEEVE	VST ↑5.23% at \$155.94 · CEG ↑4.17% at \$273.71 per data drop
MERCHANT SILICON	CRDO ↑5.49% · NVDA ↑2.93% · MRVL ↑3.31% into AMD tonight
CARSON'S SPY SUPPORT	\$645.80 active · Mon SPY range \$748.80–\$758.58 per data drop · not hit

THE PALANTIR Q2 PRINT AFTER THE CLOSE DELIVERED EPS \$0.41 VS. APPROXIMATELY \$0.35 CONSENSUS AND REVENUE \$1.94B VS. \$1.81B CONSENSUS PER YAHOO / STOCKSTORY COVERAGE WITH U.S. COMMERCIAL REVENUE ↑APPROXIMATELY 149% YEAR-OVER-YEAR, AND MANAGEMENT RAISED FULL-YEAR 2026 REVENUE GUIDANCE TO APPROXIMATELY \$8.15B (ROUGHLY 82% YEAR-OVER-YEAR GROWTH); THE READ-THROUGH POWERED THE AI-PLATFORM-ADJACENT COHORT MATERIALLY — CRDO ↑5.49% AT \$218.35, MRVL ↑3.31% AT \$193.78, NVDA ↑2.93% AT \$206.64, AND HOOD ↑4.37% AT \$90.34 PER DATA DROP — AND SETS THE TONE FOR THE AMD Q2 PRINT TONIGHT AFTER THE CLOSE PER AMD INVESTOR RELATIONS, WITH OPTIONS PRICING AN APPROXIMATELY 8.5% MOVE PER SEEKING ALPHA

Per Yahoo Finance and StockStory coverage of the Monday after-close print, Palantir Technologies delivered Q2 EPS \$0.41 versus consensus near \$0.35 and revenue \$1.94B versus the \$1.81B consensus, with U.S. Commercial revenue ↑approximately 149% year-over-year, and management raised full-year 2026 revenue guidance to approximately \$8.15B (roughly 82% year-over-year growth) — a print that per pre-market coverage lifted the shares materially in extended trading. Per data drop, the Monday tape had already positioned the AI-platform-adjacent cohort into the print with SOFI ↑10.55% at \$18.03 the top FCI mover, CRDO ↑5.49% at \$218.35, HOOD ↑4.37% at \$90.34, HUT ↑4.13% at \$112.08, MRVL ↑3.31% at \$193.78, NVDA ↑2.93% at \$206.64, and SYK ↑4.76% at \$341.20 leading the growth-cyclical composition. Per AMD Investor Relations, AMD reports Q2 2026 tonight after the market close with a 5:00 PM ET / 2:00 PM PT conference call, and per company guidance revenues of \$11.2B (±\$300M) at the mid-point represent approximately 46% year-over-year growth; per Seeking Alpha coverage of the AMD options market, contracts are pricing an approximately 8.5% move in either direction. Per Bloomberg headlines cited across last week's tape, the September FOMC remains genuinely live in either direction into the Friday BLS nonfarm payrolls release per BLS schedule following the 9-3 hawkish hold, the 1.5% Q2 GDP advance per BEA, and June Core PCE cooling to 3.3% year-over-year per BEA. **The physical world matters.**

Monday's composition reset the dominant catalyst from Iran-diplomatic-implementation risk to the OPEC+ supply pivot and the AI-platform validation from Palantir — the Upstream sleeve absorbed a fundamental crude repricing while the Utility-AI-power and merchant-silicon cohorts captured the load-growth bid; the AMD after-close print tonight and Friday's NFP release remain the operative catalyst window into which pre-committed deployment tranches over impulse reaction hold as the FCI framework. Simplicity Over Complexity.

Geopolitics — The Iran Diplomatic Framing Turned Materially More Ambiguous Monday as President Trump Publicly Characterized Iranian Leadership as Duplicitious per CNN / NBC News / CNBC After Tehran's Foreign Ministry Spokesman Esmail Baghaei Said Iran Was Focused Only on Negotiations With Oman Regarding the Strait of Hormuz, With Trump Framing the Current Window as a Final Opportunity per Al Jazeera; A Ship Was Reportedly Struck in Hormuz per Reuters Headlines in the Data Drop Even as the Physical-Crude Complex Repriced Sharply Lower on the OPEC+ 7 Weekend Decision to Complete the Voluntary-Cut Rollback per Al Arabiya / CNBC / Forbes

PER CNN / NBC NEWS / CNBC COVERAGE OF THE MONDAY SEQUENCE, PRESIDENT TRUMP PUBLICLY ACCUSED IRANIAN LEADERSHIP OF DUPLICITY IN A TRUTH SOCIAL POST AFTER IRANIAN FOREIGN MINISTRY SPOKESMAN ESMAEL BAGHAEI SAID IRAN WAS FOCUSED ONLY ON NEGOTIATIONS WITH OMAN REGARDING SHIPPING THROUGH THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ — A DIRECT CONTRADICTION OF THE WEEKEND FRAMING PER CNBC / TASS / EURONEWS THAT NUCLEAR AND HORMUZ TALKS WOULD BEGIN MONDAY AFTERNOON; PER AL JAZEERA, TRUMP FRAMED THE CURRENT WINDOW AS A FINAL OPPORTUNITY FOR IRAN TO REACH A DEAL WHILE SAYING HE HAS NO TIME CONSTRAINTS ON NEGOTIATIONS, AND PER CBS NEWS, VICE PRESIDENT VANCE REPORTEDLY INDICATED IRAN WOULD PERMIT INTERNATIONAL NUCLEAR INSPECTIONS TO RESUME FOLLOWING A CONSTRUCTIVE SESSION OF TALKS — THE POSITIONING ASYMMETRY SHARPENED THE TAIL-RISK DISTRIBUTION ON THE FRONT-MONTH CRUDE COMPLEX

Per CNN, NBC News, and CNBC coverage of the Monday communications, President Trump used a Truth Social post to accuse Iranian leadership of duplicity after Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baghaei said Iran was focused only on negotiations with Oman regarding shipping through the Strait of Hormuz — a direct contradiction of the weekend framing per CNBC, TASS, and Euronews under which nuclear and Hormuz talks were to begin Monday afternoon. Per Al Jazeera coverage, Trump characterized the current window as a final opportunity for Iran to reach an agreement while also stating he has no time constraints on negotiations. Per CBS News coverage of the same window, Vice President Vance reportedly indicated Iran would permit international nuclear inspections to resume following a constructive session of talks — a framing that added a further layer of narrative crossflow into an already ambiguous positioning sequence. Per Reuters headlines captured in the data drop, a ship was reportedly struck in the Strait of Hormuz even as the physical-crude complex repriced sharply lower, and per Reuters coverage of the corporate tape, BP's Q2 profit more than doubled to top \$5B and Aramco posted a 44% rise in net profit as the Iran war drove up oil prices in the reference quarter — the cash-flow anchor for the physical-crude complex that would need to give back materially should the OPEC+ supply pivot combined with the diplomatic trajectory sustain the crude repricing. For the FCI Upstream and Defense sleeves, the composition frames a sharpened symmetric-risk distribution: a genuine implementation trajectory combined with the OPEC+ supply increase would deepen the physical-crude repricing against the Upstream sleeve (CVX \$193.18 ↓1.85%, OKE \$88.24 ↓2.83%, CNX \$36.04 ↑0.67% per data drop), while a Hormuz kinetic re-escalation would carry a symmetric reversal risk in the Defense sleeve (LMT \$586.29 ↑0.61%, GD \$382.43 ↓0.26% per data drop). **The physical world matters.**

THE OPEC+ 7 WEEKEND DECISION TO RAISE SEPTEMBER OUTPUT BY 188,000 BPD PER AL ARABIYA / CNBC / FORBES / RIGZONE COMPLETES THE PHASED ROLLBACK OF THE 1.65 MILLION BPD VOLUNTARY CUT ORIGINALLY AGREED IN 2023 — A FUNDAMENTAL SUPPLY PIVOT THAT COMBINED WITH THE DIPLOMATIC FRAMING TO DRIVE WTI (USO) APPROXIMATELY ↓5.46% AND BRENT (BNO) APPROXIMATELY ↓5.06% PER DATA DROP; PER REUTERS HEADLINES CAPTURED IN THE DATA DROP, THE SEPTEMBER ADD-BACK IS FRAMED AS CONSEQUENTIAL OVER THE LONGER HORIZON RATHER THAN THE NEAR TERM — A FRAMING CONSISTENT WITH THE ADD-BACK LANDING INTO

AN ALREADY SOFTENING FRONT-MONTH STRUCTURAL SETUP

Per Al Arabiya, CNBC, Forbes, and Rigzone coverage of the OPEC+ 7 Sunday virtual meeting, Saudi Arabia, Russia, Iraq, Kuwait, Kazakhstan, Algeria and Oman agreed to raise September output by 188,000 bpd — comprised of 62,000 bpd each from Saudi Arabia and Russia, 26,000 bpd from Iraq, 16,000 bpd from Kuwait, 10,000 bpd from Kazakhstan, 6,000 bpd from Algeria, and 5,000 bpd from Oman — completing the phased rollback of the 1.65 million bpd voluntary

supply cut first announced in April 2023. Per Reuters headlines captured in the data drop, the OPEC+ output hike is framed as more consequential over a longer horizon than in the near term — framing consistent with the September add-back landing into an already softening front-month structural setup that the diplomatic trajectory would compound. For FCI positioning, the composition anchors a structurally different Upstream sleeve context than the July kinetic-escalation window under which Chevron’s approximately \$12.1B Q2 profit per GuruFocus and Shell’s approximately \$9.8B Q2 doubling had repriced the cash-flow architecture. Per data drop, OKE closed ↓2.83% at \$88.24 despite the Q2 earnings and revenues beat per Yahoo Finance coverage of the pre-market print, illustrating that the physical-crude and midstream-fee complex is now trading against a supply-side pivot rather than a headline sequence. Carson’s active SPY support at \$645.80 per levels.json remains untouched through Monday’s \$748.80–\$758.58 intraday range per data drop and sits approximately 14% below the current tape — a level that would only come into scope in the event of a sustained downside catalyst sequence rather than a single-session crude reset. **Avoid Erosion.**

TRUMP — TRUTH SOCIAL	Publicly accused Iranian leadership of duplicity per CNN / NBC News / CNBC
IRAN — MFA BAGHAEI	Focused only on Oman talks re: Hormuz shipping per CNN / NBC News
TRUMP FRAMING	Characterized current window as a final opportunity for Iran per Al Jazeera · no time constraint
VANCE — NUCLEAR INSPECTIONS	Iran would permit IAEA inspections to resume after a constructive session per CBS News
HORMUZ SHIP STRIKE	Ship reportedly struck in Hormuz per Reuters headlines in data drop
OPEC+ SEPTEMBER	+188,000 bpd · completes rollback of 1.65M bpd voluntary cuts per Al Arabiya / CNBC / Forbes
BP Q2	Profit more than doubled to top \$5B per Reuters · on the Iran war oil surge
ARAMCO Q2	Net profit ↑44% per Reuters · on the reference-quarter crude repricing
OPEC+ — REUTERS FRAMING	Add-back framed as more consequential over the longer horizon than near term per Reuters

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. AMD Reports Q2 2026 Tonight After the Market Close With a 5:00 PM ET Conference Call per AMD Investor Relations — Company Guidance Points to Approximately \$11.2B (±\$300M) Revenue Representing Approximately 46% Year-Over-Year Growth at the Mid-Point, With Wall Street Consensus Near \$11.3B Revenue / EPS \$1.61 per TipRanks / Seeking Alpha, and Options Pricing an Approximately 8.5% Move per Seeking Alpha; AMD Closed Monday ↑1.78% at \$484.64 per Data Drop After the Merchant-Silicon Cohort Ripped Materially on the Palantir Q2 Beat, With Focus on the Helios Rack-Scale Order Book, MI350 Shipments, and Data-Center Accelerator Guidance Into the September FOMC. Per AMD Investor Relations, AMD reports fiscal Q2 2026 today at 5:00 PM ET / 2:00 PM PT. Per TipRanks and Seeking Alpha coverage, Wall Street consensus centers near revenue approximately \$11.3B and EPS \$1.61, above the company’s \$11.2B (±\$300M) mid-point that implies approximately 46% year-over-year growth, and per Seeking Alpha coverage of the options market, contracts are pricing an approximately 8.5% move in either direction (implied range approximately \$440.39–\$522.67). Per data drop, AMD closed Monday ↑1.78% at \$484.64 alongside CRDO ↑5.49% at \$218.35, MRVL ↑3.31% at \$193.78, and NVDA ↑2.93% at \$206.64 as the merchant-silicon cohort ripped on the Palantir Q2 beat. Per Yahoo, Citigroup reportedly added AMD ahead of the print, with the analyst seeing over 40% upside potential on a well-executed quarter. The read for the FCI Growth sleeve extends to the data-center accelerator demand signal, memory-cost pass-through, and the Helios rack-scale order book that would anchor the merchant-silicon competitive read against NVDA. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. Caterpillar (CAT) Reports Q2 2026 This Morning Pre-Market With Results at 5:30 AM CDT and a 7:30 AM CDT Conference Call per Pluang — Zacks Consensus EPS \$6.25 (Implying Approximately 32% Growth Year-Over-Year) and Revenue \$19.31B (Approximately 16.6% Year-Over-Year Growth) per Yahoo Finance; CAT Closed Monday ↑1.87% at \$830.03 per Data Drop Into the Print, and the Read Delivers the Industrials-Cyclical and Data-Center Physical-Infrastructure Signal Into a Composition Where the ISM Manufacturing PMI Printed 55.6 — the Highest Reading Since May 2022 per Reuters / ISM. Per Pluang coverage, Caterpillar releases Q2 2026 results this morning at 5:30 AM CDT with a 7:30 AM CDT conference call. Per Yahoo Finance

coverage of the Zacks consensus, EPS is expected near \$6.25 (approximately 32% year-over-year growth) with revenue near \$19.31B (approximately 16.6% growth), and CAT has beaten Zacks consensus in three of the trailing four quarters at an average surprise near 9.62%. Per data drop, CAT closed Monday ↑1.87% at \$830.03 into the print, and the FCI Dividend sleeve read (also including SYK ↑4.76%, ADP ↑1.25%, and STLD ↑2.83% Monday per data drop) sits into the ISM Manufacturing PMI 55.6 print alongside the Iran diplomatic ambiguity. A constructive volume and Energy & Transportation segment guide combined with the load-growth capture composition anchors the physical-world thesis into the September FOMC. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. The Tuesday Economic Calendar Delivers a Dense Cluster at 10:00 AM ET per Investrade / Earnings Whispers — JOLTS Job Openings for June, Factory Orders M/M for June, and Durable Goods M/M for June All Print Simultaneously, With Advance Goods Trade and International Trade Data at 8:30 AM ET; The Cluster Frames the Fed Reaction Function Into Friday's BLS Nonfarm Payrolls Release per BLS Schedule and Follows Monday's ISM Manufacturing PMI Beat at 55.6 That Marked the Highest Reading Since May 2022 per Reuters /

ISM. Per Investrade and Earnings Whispers week-ahead coverage, Tuesday delivers a 10:00 AM ET cluster: JOLTS Job Openings for June, Factory Orders M/M for June, and Durable Goods M/M for June all print simultaneously, with the June Advance Goods Trade Balance and International Trade at 8:30 AM ET and API weekly inventory data at 4:30 PM ET into the AMD after-close print. Per BLS release schedule, the July nonfarm payrolls report lands Friday, August 7 at 8:30 AM ET into a labor context where June printed +57,000 jobs per Trading Economics coverage referenced across prior briefs. For the FCI Dividend and Growth sleeves, the composition — ISM Manufacturing PMI 55.6, the OPEC+ September supply pivot, and the Iran diplomatic ambiguity — keeps the September FOMC genuinely live in either direction, and any material JOLTS surprise combined with the AMD print would materially reset positioning into the balance of the week. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

4. Vistra (VST) Reports Q2 2026 Friday, August 7 Pre-Market With a 10:00 AM ET Conference Call per StockTitan / Marketbeat — Analyst Consensus Near \$2.43 EPS (Up Approximately 140% Year-Over-Year From \$1.01) per Barchart / Yahoo Finance, With VST Closing Monday ↑5.23% at \$155.94 per Data Drop and CEG ↑4.17% at \$273.71 Into a Session Where the Utility-AI-Power Cohort Rerated Sharply on the Load-Growth Read; The Print Combines With the Friday BLS Nonfarm Payrolls Release per BLS Schedule to Set the AI-Power Sleeve's

Crystallization for the Balance of the Year. Per StockTitan and Marketbeat coverage, Vistra reports Q2 2026 Friday, August 7 pre-market with a 10:00 AM ET conference call. Per Barchart and Yahoo Finance coverage of the analyst consensus, VST is expected to report approximately \$2.43 EPS versus \$1.01 in the year-ago quarter, and for the full year analysts expect EPS near \$9.53 (approximately 81% growth from fiscal 2025). Per data drop, VST closed Monday ↑5.23% at \$155.94 and CEG closed ↑4.17% at \$273.71 into the print alongside NEE \$86.55 ↓0.43% as the Utility-AI-power cohort rerated on the load-growth read. The Friday-morning VST print alongside the July nonfarm payrolls release per BLS schedule crystallizes the FCI Utility-AI sleeve into a materially eventful pre-open session,

with focus on load-growth capture, hyperscaler contracting cadence, and the memory-cost / CapEx pass-through framing that Amazon's \$220B cash CapEx guide anchored during the prior week. *The physical world matters.*

5. FCI Dispersion Watch — SOFI Closed Monday ↑10.55% at \$18.03 as the Top FCI Mover per Data Drop on the Post-Earnings Rebound per Benzinga, With CRDO ↑5.49%, VST ↑5.23%, SYK ↑4.76%, and HOOD ↑4.37% Rounding the Top Five; The Bottom Five Ran NTR ↓4.50%, OKE ↓2.83% (Despite the Q2 Beat per Yahoo), EIX ↓2.60% (Post-Q2 Earnings Transcript per Yahoo), NXPI ↓2.18%, and CVX ↓1.85% per Data Drop on the Crude Repricing; The Dispersion Illustrates the Split Between the Load-Growth / AI-Adjacent Cohort and the Physical-Crude Complex Into the AMD After-Close Print Tonight. Per data drop, SOFI closed Monday ↑10.55% at \$18.03 as the top FCI mover on the post-earnings rebound per Benzinga coverage, followed by CRDO ↑5.49% at \$218.35, VST ↑5.23% at \$155.94, SYK ↑4.76% at \$341.20, and HOOD ↑4.37% at \$90.34 in the top five. Per data drop, the bottom five ran NTR ↓4.50% at \$65.96, OKE ↓2.83% at \$88.24 (despite the Q2 EPS and revenue beat per Yahoo Finance coverage of the pre-market print), EIX ↓2.60% at \$71.46 (into the Q2 earnings call transcript per Yahoo), NXPI ↓2.18% at \$224.17, and CVX ↓1.85% at \$193.18 on the crude repricing. The dispersion illustrates the split between the load-growth / AI-adjacent cohort and the physical-crude complex into the AMD after-close print tonight, and reinforces the FCI framework of pre-committed deployment discipline over single-catalyst impulse responses. *Think Like an Owner.*

6. Carson's SPY Support at \$645.80 Remains Untouched Through Monday's \$748.80–\$758.58 Intraday Range per Data Drop and levels.json — The Retracement Target Sits Approximately 14% Below the Current Tape; The Materially Dense Catalyst Window — AMD Q2 Tonight, CAT Q2 Pre-Market Today, the Tuesday 10:00 AM ET Economic Cluster (JOLTS / Factory Orders / Durable Goods), the Continuing Iran Diplomatic Ambiguity, the OPEC+ Supply Pivot, VST Q2 Friday Pre-Market, and July NFP Friday at 8:30 AM ET — Reinforces the Operative FCI Discipline of the Pre-Committed Deployment Tranches (70% of Reserves at –25% Drawdown, Remaining 30% at –40%) Rather Than Impulse Reaction to Any Single Catalyst Window.

Per levels.json, Carson's active SPY support at \$645.80 — the retracement target set April 13 — remains untouched through Monday's \$748.80–\$758.58 intraday range per data drop and sits approximately 14% below the current tape. The prior major resistance zone at \$691.90–\$693.20 was cleared on April 14 per levels.json and is not a live reference point. For the FCI risk framework, the composition — AMD Q2 tonight, CAT Q2 pre-market today, the Tuesday 10:00 AM ET economic cluster, the Iran diplomatic ambiguity with the Hormuz ship strike per Reuters, the OPEC+ September supply pivot, VST Q2 Friday pre-market, and July NFP Friday at 8:30 AM ET per BLS schedule — frames a materially dense catalyst window, and the pre-committed deployment tranches (70% of reserves at –25% drawdown, remaining 30% at –40%) remain the operative discipline through the sequence rather than any impulse response. *Avoid Erosion.*

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